confused look McCullum gives back, the sound of the crowd. The off stump, thrown out of the ground, even lands in the exact same place. It's like science and art interacting with each other, providing measurable results. It all makes perfect sense, suddenly so within my power. If I do this, this will happen, and this is what gives me value and makes other people happy. It's all so simple. Ross Taylor is soon gone too, a similar ball, this time finding the more acute sound of an outside edge – pure and exact – and reaching Pietersen safely at gully.

Daniel Flynn is next. A left-hander, I find an angle to him, going back in, hitting him on the pads in front of the stumps. I don't even need to turn around. Out. Hanging the ball outside off stump to Jamie How, a fraction shorter of a length, drawing him into a shot, edging behind to Tim Ambrose. Out. Then a mirrored dismissal to Jacob Oram – this time bowling an out-swinger short of a length to tempt him into playing at a ball. Out. When I get Gareth Hopkins out finally, another ball that swings away, this time a satisfying, dull thud of a pad in front of the stumps, out LBW, I have taken the wickets of the entire New Zealand top order. Seven wickets for 43 runs. Cricket has never felt so easy, so simple to enact or been so within my grasp. I would be happy to stay there forever, bowling at batters endlessly, seeing what would happen before it actually did, and then playing it out in reality. Out here I have an answer for every question that is asked of me. Nothing is complicated. Everything is measured. Everything is definable. And today, I leave with my record figures so far for England. We win by an innings.